



Learning how to type. Pupils of Kudobou School in Eritrea learning how to use the computer keyboard. NRC supported the installation of solar power systems in schools to establish computer laboratories across the country.

ERITREA | Vocational skills for youth

The UN estimated that 5,000 Eritreans fled the country every month in 2016, a majority of them to and through Ethiopia. The country hosted some 162,000 Eritreans by November 2016. Those leaving Eritrea were mainly young people and included large numbers of unaccompanied children. This posed a major challenge to the region, as refugees and migrants were exposed to major protection concerns such as human trafficking, smuggling, kidnapping and torture for ransom.

NRC's vocational skills training in Eritrea was implemented in partnership with the Ministry of Education and mainly targeted out-of-school youth. Building skills for youth offered better and diverse job opportunities, reliable sources of livelihood and helped to make youth self-reliant.

The project supported graduates to either seek employment from the existing private sector or with start-up kits and capital, start their own business. The graduates were encouraged to form groups or cooperatives, as well obtain materials and financial support from the local government. The project offered a six-month post-monitoring programme and coaching for all graduates, including offering short workshops on business management and cashbook skills.

NRC also supported the installation of solar power systems in schools to establish computer laboratories across the country. The solar facilities were able to run more than 30 computers, supply power to the library, administrative blocks and classrooms. The computer labs located in the remote parts of the country were instrumental in bridging the digital divide.

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